

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Linux

Here are some bouncers from the vault of Linux jargon to help you leave your friends reeling.

Framebuffer

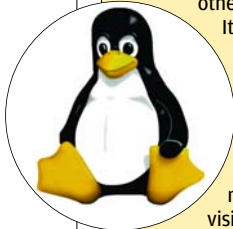
The Linux framebuffer or fbdev is a graphics layer to show graphics on a console. It is hardware-independent and it does not rely on system-specific binaries. It is also lightweight, unlike the X Windows system.

It was originally developed for Apple Macintosh computers. These do not have a text-mode display, so it was developed so the text-mode could be emulated. It was later expanded to the IBM PC platform and became popular.

LSB

LSB is an acronym for The Linux Standard Base—a joint project by several Linux distributions. It was set under The Free Standards Groups, with the objectives of standardising the internal structure of Linux OSes. It is based on POSIX and several other open standards.

It is sometimes disputed, as it promotes Red Hat's RPM format, so Debian does not accept it. For more information, visit linuxbase.org.



Staog

Viruses on Linux OSes are rare; however, many viruses for Linux have been found, and Staog was the first of them. It was found in late 1996. Some other Linux viruses are Bliss, Devnull, Ramen, Slapper, Adore, and Kork.

LAMP

An acronym for a set of free software to run dynamic web sites, it includes Linux, Apache, MySQL and PHP. These programs were originally not designed to run together, but they became popular because of low cost and easy availability. This term first appeared in a German computing magazine (- c't), in 1998. Lamp is also the name of an obsolete movie player software.

Kudos From The South

Digit had been down south to meet Chief Minister of Karnataka N Dharamsingh. Digit's operations manager Shailesh Iyer and operations general manager Shivshankar Hiremath Manasivanagi presented the all-new redesigned issue of Digit to the new chief minister, who was so impressed with the content in the magazine that he read almost every single page.

Dharamsingh also briefed the *Digit* team on the steps his Government had initiated to promote the growth of IT in Karnataka. At present, his government's IT ministry is

DIGIT DIARY

working on the education module to promote information technology.

He said it was Digit's classy design that caught his attention. He went through the articles and found them informative. He then did something remarkable—he said he will try to read Digit every month to keep abreast of technology. He also hoped that technology magazines like *Digit* reached



Digit's general manager, operations, Shivshankar Hiremath presents the re-designed Digit to Karnataka Chief Minister N Dharamsingh

every corner of Karnataka. He also invited Digit to be present the prestigious Bangalore IT.com and Bio Tech, both of which are held in November 2004.

We will be there!

use the video as an experiment into how quickly such items spread over the Internet; as it took months for the video to spread, he was reportedly disappointed over the result.

The FBI questioned him after the hoax became public. "We will pursue any and all legal avenues for prosecution," said FBI special agent LaRae Quay.

THE LAW IS AN...

My Lawyer Will Bury Yours

We will give away the ending to this one: Don't mess with lawyers. Here is a familiar story—you step onto an online message board and it is filled with flames, derogatorily condemning you and everything you stand for in front of the amused masses. All part of the Internet experience: you are expected to take it on the chin and move on.

Not if you represent a

law firm, though. Stephen Galton, a California lawyer and partner in legal firm Galton & Helm was subjected to a "barrage of harassing, defamatory and abusive messages" and he came away with a class action suit! The messages



information of their users.

Galton also alleges that Yahoo! does not rectify the wrong people have suffered as abuse via its message boards. He would also like to see similar victims band together for the class action lawsuit. Like probably showing their support by handing in bags of money to his law firm. For a good cause, of course.

NANO WONDER

Metal Rubber!

were posted on boards supported by Yahoo!, criticising one of Galton's clients. When the lawyer in question signed up to the board and defended the client he was ridiculed by other users.

When Yahoo! refused to divulge the details of the users who allegedly harassed Galton, he sued the company for the information. A company when legally asked to do so is bound to release erstwhile confidential

Chalk one up for Cnanotechnology. NanoSonic in Blacksburg, Virginia, has successfully created a new substance that marries the strength of metal with the flexibility afforded by polymers. The process involved is deceptively simple. Two buckets, one filled with positively charged metallic ions and the other with negatively charged elastic polymers are involved. A charged substrate is taken and is first dipped into one of the buckets, which